Business Growth in the World Confectionery Market

Exam code: 9BS0

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Written by: Lisa Eades
Reviewed by: Steve Vorster
Updated on 27 January 2026

Confectionery growth

- The global confectionery market is **much larger than the UK market** and is forecast to keep growing over the next decade
- Research organisations estimate that global confectionery was worth **about US$214bn in 2024**, with forecasts rising to **about US$278bn by 2032**
- Drivers of global growth include:
  - **Mature markets**, such as the UK and much of Western Europe, that grow slowly
  - **Higher-growth markets**, especially in parts of Asia, where rising incomes and urbanisation are increasing demand for branded snacks
- Europe is still a major region for confectionery consumption and value at **around 38% of the market in 2023**

Global market size and forecast

Year	Global confectionery market value (US$ bn)	What this suggests
2023	206.97	• Very large market already, so growth is steady rather than explosive
2024	213.74	• Growth continues even with cost pressures
2032 (forecast)	278.36	• Long-term growth is expected to continue

- This estimate suggests a growth rate of **about 3.36% per year from 2024–2032**
  - Different market reports give different forecasts, because they use different definitions (for example,

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Got it

- **Chocolate confectionery is the largest market segment**
  - Chocolate is popular across many countries
  - Growth may be slowed by high cocoa costs and price sensitivity, especially when inflation is high
- **Sugar confectionery is set to achieve faster growth in some forecasts**
  - Innovation is easier because new flavours and textures can be launched quickly, such as gummies and chewy sweets
  - There is strong youth appeal in some markets

Regional growth patterns

- Global growth is not evenly spread
- In general, **mature markets** grow more slowly because most consumers already buy confectionery regularly
- **Emerging markets** can grow faster as incomes rise and modern retail expands

Region	Growth patterns	Growth drivers

Europe	• Europe accounts for a **very large share of global confectionery sales by value**
	• Growth across the region is typically **slow and steady** because
	  ○ Most European consumers already buy confectionery frequently
	  ○ Population growth is low in many European countries
	  ○ Markets such as the UK, Germany and France are highly competitive and saturated
		• Growth in Europe is therefore driven mainly by:
		  ○ Price increases
		  ○ Premiumisation
		  ○ Product innovation rather than higher sales volumes
		• Europe offers **low risk but limited growth potential**, which suits established brands but provides fewer opportunities for rapid expansion

North America	• North America, particularly the United States, is another **large and mature confectionery market**
	• Growth in this region is:
		• Key factors influencing growth include:
		  ○ Strong demand for chocolate and snack products
		  ○ Premium and sharing formats

Help me understand

	○ Still relatively modest compared to emerging markets	concerns and sugar reduction pressures limit volume growth • For multinational firms, North America provides **stable revenues** but limited long-term growth
Latin America	• Latin America is often described as a **medium-to-high growth region** for confectionery	• Growth in this region is driven by: ○ A relatively young population ○ Strong cultural acceptance of sweet snacks ○ Increasing availability of branded products through modern retail • However, growth can be **uneven** due to: ○ Economic instability in some countries ○ High inflation and currency volatility • This makes Latin America an attractive but **higher-risk growth market** for global businesses
Asia-Pacific	• Asia-Pacific is widely seen as the **fastest-growing region** in the global confectionery market	• Growth is supported by several structural factors: ○ Rising incomes and expanding middle classes in countries such as China and India ○ Rapid urbanisation, leading to greater demand for packaged snacks

		as supermarkets and convenience stores ○ Expansion of e-commerce and mobile shopping • Although growth rates vary widely between countries, the region offers **significant long-term growth potential**, making it a key focus for multinational investment

Middle East & Africa	• The Middle East and Africa represent a **smaller share of global confectionery sales**, but they are increasingly important for future growth.	• Growth is supported by:
		  ○ Rapid population growth in many African countries
		  ○ Urbanisation and expansion of retail infrastructure
		  ○ Growing demand for affordable treats
		• However, growth is limited by:
		  ○ Lower average incomes
		  ○ Political and economic instability in some regions
		• As a result, this region offers **long-term potential**, but growth is slower and less predictable.

Biscuits growth

- Biscuits are sometimes treated as a separate market from confectionery

online)

- Sources suggest the **global biscuits and cookies market** could grow from **US$87.39bn in 2023** to **US$120.15bn by 2031**, which is **4.1% growth**

Global biscuits and cookies market growth

Year	Global market value (US$ bn)	What this suggests
2023	87.39	• Large, established category with strong everyday demand
2031 (forecast)	120.15	• Faster growth than many confectionery estimates

Reasons for strong global growth

Adaptability | Match routines | Health & lifestyle trends

- Biscuits are easy to adapt to local tastes
  - Flavours, sweetness levels and textures can be adjusted for different countries
- They fit everyday routines
  - Biscuits are often bought as repeat cup of tea / snack items, not just for gifting
- They link to health and lifestyle trends
  - Growth areas often include free-from, lower sugar, and premium indulgent cookies

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